

Arrival choices

Previous lesson reminder:

Start with 1 and 2. Try 3 and 4 when ready. Reading and exact scribing are available.

1 What was the immediate trigger for British and French declarations?

Support: Use the reminder strip or talk it through with an adult.

My response

2 Which meaning fits conflict?

Support: Choose: A serious struggle including war OR Deliberate unfair targeting of a group.

My response

3 Who perpetrated the Holocaust and who was its central target?

Support: Use the model evidence anchor B or read one relevant card together.

My response

4 Was the Holocaust simply another word for all wartime deaths?

Support: Give a reason when ready.

My response

Stretch: use a precise example or explain which detail supports your answer.

Evidence cards

Read, point or listen. Keep the source label with any detail you use.

P Factors before September 1939

Nazi expansion brought Austria and the Sudetenland under German control in 1938; German forces occupied the Czech lands in 1939. Repeated expansion and the later invasion of Poland help explain the widening conflict.

Source: USHMM Introduction to the Holocaust, territorial expansion context

Limit: These selected factors do not exhaust the diplomatic, economic and ideological causes.

A Europe in 1939

Nazi Germany's expansion and invasion of Poland on 1 September 1939 led Britain and France to declare war on 3 September. Longer-term conditions and leaders' choices help explain the conflict.

Source: USHMM historical context

Limit: A sequence of dates alone is not a complete causal explanation.

B The Holocaust

The Holocaust was the systematic persecution and murder of six million European Jews by Nazi Germany and its allies and collaborators. Persecution developed from 1933; the genocide took place during the Second World War. Nazi policies also persecuted and murdered other groups.

Source: United States Holocaust Memorial Museum

Limit: Do not collapse different groups' histories into identical experiences or treat genocide as inevitable.

C Gerda Haas remembers Ansbach

In her later oral history, Gerda Schild Haas recalls that religion mattered in her family. She describes Jewish affiliation appearing on forms and in community life in Ansbach before persecution.

Source: US Holocaust Memorial Museum oral history; Gerda Haas, prewar community life in Ansbach

Limit: This is a later remembered account of her experience. Broad generalisations in the full interview should not be treated as a survey of every Jewish family.

Evidence cards continued

Read, point or listen. Keep the source label with any detail you use.

D Remembrance choices

An accurate memorial can name a person, recognise a life and credit evidence. A simple layout, readable text and a clear source can support respectful attention.

Source: Authored memorial design guidance

Limit: Avoid invented quotations, dramatic effects, graphic imagery and victim or perpetrator role-play.

Shared investigation

1. Establish factual context and the meanings of antisemitism, persecution and genocide.
2. Examine a calm remembrance example.

Work with a partner or adult, or use your own table. One person suggests; the other checks the evidence. Swap after one turn. Passing is allowed.

Move or match the cards

Cards to use
Lives before persecution matter
All experiences were identical
Antisemitism was central

Possible labels: Not established / Respectful context / Supported

Our explanation

Support: Use the glossary and one chunk of evidence. Plan the claim and supporting detail before explaining.

Further challenge: Explain why Jewish life before persecution should also be represented.

Supported independent task

Complete this route only. Study the Holocaust sensitively linked to Holocaust Memorial Day.

1. Write an accurate contextual response explaining what the Holocaust was.
2. Create a brief memorial statement grounded in a source.
3. Explain one word or design choice without inventing testimony.

Support: Use the glossary and one chunk of evidence. Plan the claim and supporting detail before explaining. Complete the organiser one space at a time. The Holocaust was _____. The source establishes _____. I chose _____ to recognise _____.

Source label and origin

A detail I can point to

What this detail helps me explain

What I still need to check

An adult may read or scribe your exact response. They should not choose the answer.

Standard independent task

Complete this route only. Study the Holocaust sensitively linked to Holocaust Memorial Day.

1. Write an accurate contextual response explaining what the Holocaust was.
2. Create a brief memorial statement grounded in a source.
3. Explain one word or design choice without inventing testimony.

Support: The Holocaust was _____. The source establishes _____. I chose _____ to recognise _____.

Source label and origin

A detail I can point to

What this detail helps me explain

What I still need to check

Check the required evidence and revise one detail.

Stretch independent task

Complete this route only. Study the Holocaust sensitively linked to Holocaust Memorial Day.

1. Write an accurate contextual response explaining what the Holocaust was.
2. Create a brief memorial statement grounded in a source.
3. Explain one word or design choice without inventing testimony.
4. Explain why Jewish life before persecution should also be represented.

Support: Choose the evidence independently. Use the frame only if it helps.

Source label and origin

A detail I can point to

What this detail helps me explain

What I still need to check

Explain why Jewish life before persecution should also be represented.

Exit ticket

Choose a response mode. You may give your answers privately to an adult.

Who perpetrated the Holocaust and who was its central target?

My response

Was the Holocaust simply another word for all wartime deaths?

My response

Support: The Holocaust was _____. The source establishes _____. I chose _____ to recognise _____.

Further challenge: Explain why Jewish life before persecution should also be represented.

One thing I changed or want to check
